

A daily scan of national and South Yorkshire developments in education policy, inclusion, SEND, behaviour and accountability — weighted to primary and evidence sources, with links and a clear “so what for your school” line on the items that matter.

Useful? Forward it to a colleague. To join the circulation or partner with the network, [get in touch](#).

TOP LINE

- A quiet day - no major new policy, inspection or funding story broke nationally or locally in the last 24-48 hours.
- The clearest update: Ofsted has confirmed it is extending the pause on routine inspections of National Professional Qualification (NPQ) and early career teacher programme (ECTP) providers through the rest of 2026/27, with normal inspections not resuming until 2027/28.
→ **For your school:** Useful if any staff ask why their NPQ or ECT provider hasn't had a routine Ofsted visit this year.
- Nothing fresh has broken locally beyond routine council business - worth using the lull to get ahead of half term and the 16 October Year 7 applications deadline (see diary).

DATES FOR THE DIARY

16 Oct 2026 — Midday deadline for Sheffield secondary school applications for September 2027 entry (national deadline 31 Oct).

26-30 Oct 2026 — Sheffield schools' autumn half term.

■ NATIONAL: OFSTED EXTENDS PAUSE ON NPQ AND EARLY-CAREER-TEACHER INSPECTIONS

- **Ofsted has confirmed a further pause on routine inspections of providers running National Professional Qualifications, now extended to also cover early career teacher programme providers.**

The pause - requested by the Minister for School Standards - runs through the rest of the 2026/27 academic year. Ofsted says it needs the time to bring NPQ and ECTP inspection into line with its current inspection approach, including a new toolkit, operating guide and report card, with sector engagement to follow. Routine inspections are expected to resume in 2027/28. ([GOV.UK - Ofsted news](#))

→ **For your school:** Worth a line to CPD leads and anyone currently on an NPQ or supporting an ECT, so they know the lack of a provider inspection this year is expected, not a gap.

JARGON-BUSTER - NPQ & ECTP

Both paused from routine Ofsted inspection this year:

NPQ (National Professional Qualification) - DfE-funded leadership and specialist qualifications for teachers and leaders. ECTP (Early Career Teacher Programme) - the structured two-year induction support for newly qualified teachers, formerly the ECF.

MAPS IN PRACTICE - TOOL SPOTLIGHT: SCHOOL+

A strong inclusion strategy is only as good as the cohort picture beneath it.

School+ is the MAPs cohort-vulnerability framework — it maps who your at-risk pupils are and why, giving your inclusion strategy an evidence base rather than a wish list. [Explore School+](#)

■ SOURCES MONITORED

Weighted official- and evidence-first. X is monitored for early signals from official accounts and named commentators, and corroborated against a primary source before anything is included.

Source	Type	What we track
OFFICIAL & STATUTORY		
DfE / GOV.UK	Government	Policy, funding, statutory guidance and statistics
Ofsted	Government	Inspection framework, report cards, annual report
Explore Education Statistics	Government data	Exclusions, suspensions, attendance, census data
House of Commons Library	Parliament	Neutral briefings on bills and policy
RESEARCH & EVIDENCE		
Education Endowment Foundation	Research	Evidence-based guidance, incl. inclusive teaching
NFER	Research	Assessment, workforce, disadvantage
Education Policy Institute	Think tank	Policy analysis and the disadvantage gap
Institute for Fiscal Studies	Think tank	School funding and spending analysis
FFT Education Datalab	Data analysis	Data-driven analysis of attainment and exclusions
INCLUSION & PREVENTION SPECIALISTS		
The Difference	Charity	Whole-school inclusion; "Who's Losing Learning?"
IPPR	Think tank	Lost learning, exclusions, SEND reform
Youth Endowment Fund	Research	What works to prevent youth violence & exclusion
Centre for Social Justice	Think tank	Exclusion tracker and social-mobility policy
Whole School SEND	Network	SEND practice, resources and reviews
SECTOR PRESS & COMMENTARY		
Schools Week	Press	Breaking sector news and investigations
Tes	Press	Practice, policy and workforce
The Guardian (Education)	Press	National coverage and comment
X (monitored)	Social	DfE, Ofsted, EEF and named voices — corroborated before use
LOCAL & REGIONAL		
The Star (Sheffield)	Local press	Local schools and Ofsted outcomes
Sheffield City Council	Local government	Council decisions, funding and local strategy
South Yorkshire MCA & Careers Hub	Regional	Regional skills, careers and funding

Connect Daily is part of Sheffield Connect. Compiled by Andy Marsden, Sector Inclusion Lead.

For circulation across the network and partners. Figures reflect the latest published data at the date of this brief.